

Intransitive verbs: unergatives, unaccusatives, middles (part of: Syntax of Hungarian: Verbs and Verb Phrases)

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[This chapter is work in progress. And this is not the usually modesty. This thing is very much under construction, so proceed with caution.]

1. Introduction

This chapter covers the syntactic, semantic and morphological patterns displayed by intransitive verbs in Hungarian. The discussion will be theory-neutral but informed by various theoretical approaches. No new theoretical claims will be made: rather, the aim is to provide a survey of the facts and to provide pointers to the existing theoretical literature.

Our focus is on intransitive verbs: one-argument verbs which lack any arguments in addition to the syntactic subject (since in Hungarian, nominals are overtly case-marked, and there is subject agreement, identifying the subject of a sentence is straightforward). We will broaden this definition to consider verbs which are arguable zero-argument: subjectless verbs (weather verbs and time-of-day verbs).

Argument structure is an interface phenomenon, and, as we will see, there exist systematic mismatches between argumenthood in syntactic and semantic terms. Thus, we will see instances where a verb is intransitive in syntactic terms, and yet, at the level of semantic interpretation, it has two arguments (and also instances where a syntactically subjectless and thus apparently zero-argument verbs is interpreted semantically as a one-argument verb).

We will also see that the lexically specified argument structure of verbs can be manipulated in the course of morphosyntactic derivation: thus, verbs that are born transitive can have one of their arguments suppressed (syntactically and/or semantically), and, vice versa, verbs that are born intransitive may be augmented by an additional argument.

The chapter is structured as follows. First, we will discuss zero-argument verbs: weather verbs such as *havazik* 'snow_v' and time-of-day verbs such as *hajnalodik* 'dawn_v' which at least syntactically lack a subject (and any other argument). Next, we will focus on a class of spurious intransitives: transitive verbs with implicit objects. After this, we will turn our attention to true intransitives. First we will cover intransitives that were born this way: verbs that are lexically specified as either having only one, external argument (unergatives) or only one, internal argument (unaccusatives). Next, we will consider middle voice: a morphosyntactic operation which suppresses the external or internal argument of an originally transitive verb and thus yields what we might term a derived unergative or a derived unaccusative.¹

¹ Traditionally, most authors discussing Hungarian have not made this distinction between unaccusatives and middles. E.g. Bene (2010) treats unaccusatives and middles as essentially the same category (*mediális*). Károly (1967) conflates unaccusatives and some middles (anticausatives) under the rubric *mediális*, and unergatives and some middles (antipassives and reflexives) under the rubric *bennható*. On the other hand, E. Abaffy (1978) notes the difference between middles (especially anticausatives) and unaccusatives. See Bene (2010) and E. Abaffy (1978) for a more detail historical overview.

2. Zero-argument verbs: weather verbs and time-of-day verbs

Hungarian has two sets of verbs which lack an overt subject and also appear to be argument-less on the semantic level. The first group is so-called weather verbs (also called natural phenomena verbs by some authors, cf. Németh T. 2016 and references).

- (1) a. *Sötét-ed-ik*
dark-vrb-3sg
'It is getting dark.'
- b. *Villám-l-ik*.
lightning-vrb-3sg
'Lightnings are striking.'
- c. *Hav-az-ik*.
snow-vrb-3sg
'It is snowing.'

The second group is time-of-day verbs:

- (2) a. *Hajnal-od-ik*.
dawn-vrb-3sg
'Dawn is approaching.'
- b. *Este-led-ik*.
evening-vrb-3sg
'Evening is approaching.'

According to most authors, these verbs cannot appear with an overt subject:

- (3) **Az idő* / **Ez* / **A nap sötétedik*
- (4) **A villám* / **Az ég villámlik*.
- (5) **Az időjárás* / **A hó* / **Sok csapadék havazik*.

Some authors (e.g. Németh T. 2016) argue against this consensus pointing to examples where weather verbs do have an overt argument. This involves on the one hand verbs such as *esik* 'rain/fall', *zuhog* 'fall intensively', *szakad* 'break down'; these can indisputably appear with an overt subject:

- (6) a. *Esik*.
b. *Esik az eső*.

Note, however that *esik* is actually the general-purpose verb meaning 'fall': i.e., it is not obvious that it is in fact a weather verb. The fact that (6a) is easily interpreted as (6b) may plausibly be analyzed in terms of an implicit argument ('the thing that usually falls is falling, i.e., rain'). Such an analysis may be extended to *zuhog* and *szakad* as well.

Another set of examples includes metaphorical or quasi-metaphorical usage, such as:

- (7) *Új nap virradt ránk*.

Finally, Németh T. (2016) also provides corpus attestations such as:

(8) *?Hajnalodik a nap.*

(9) *?Villámlik az ég.*

While these examples are clearly attested, most speakers, when presented with such sentences, find them unacceptable or highly marked. More work is needed to establish whether this is a case of dialectal variation or of coercion.

In terms of their morphosyntax, such verbs display a peculiar pattern: all of them are made up by nominal stem followed by a verbalizer and 3SG subject agreement morpheme (typically but not always from the irregular *-ik*-paradigm):

Many authors (e.g. Pusztaí 2003) argue that weather-verbs (and time-of-day verbs) are subjectless. Tóth (2001) argues that they have null quasi-argumental subjects. Németh T. (2016) argues that weather-verbs (and time-of-day verbs) are not subjectless: rather, their subject can optionally be implicit, i.e., they should be analyzed on par with transitives that can have implicit object argument (Bibok 2008, 2010; Németh T. 2010, 2014). Keszler (2000) posits two classes: subjectless weather verbs (such as *havasik*) and weather verbs with a subject that can be dropped (such as *esik*).

Assuming that these verbs are indeed subject-less, the question is why this obtains. Some authors (e.g. Keszler 2000) argue that this is because such verbs are used to refer to the general environment. More formally, these sentences lack a syntactic subject but semantically speaking, they have a silent subject which expones an indexical spatio-temporal argument referring to the 'the here and now' of the reference time: i.e., the world as it is at reference time. Under this analysis, the semantic interpretation is as follows:

(10) *Havasik.*

'at t_0 , the world w_0 is such that snow obtains'

(11) *Hajnalodik.*

'at t_0 , the world w_0 is such that dawn obtains'

However, the unique morphological make-up of these verbs also lends itself to another type of analysis involving incorporation (Komlósy 1994, 2001). Under this analysis, which I rephrase in current generative terms, the subject of these sentences is the noun itself, the verbalizing suffix is the exponent of a so-called light verb, and in the process of derivation, the noun and the light verb are merged to form a complex verb:

(12) *hajnal* *-od* *-ik*
dawn obtain 3sg

'Dawn obtains.'

Note that this process is in a sense the mirror image of the well-known light verb analysis of English:

(13) *I put the book on the shelf. -> I shelved the book.*

A clear advantage of this analysis is that it explains the unavailability of an overt subject, the availability of 3SG subject agreement, and also delivers the right semantic interpretation. One complication is that in addition to nouns, adjectives also appear in weather verbs (time-of-day verbs) and it is at first sight not straightforward how these can occupy the subject position (normally reserved to nominals) and denote concepts (again a function normally reserved to nominals). This issue is less serious than it first

seems: note that in Hungarian, adjectives are fairly easily converted to nouns without any morphological marking:

(14) *Leszállt a sötét.*

'Darkness has descended.'

3. Spurious intransitives: transitives with implicit objects

Spurious intransitives involve cases where a verb apparently lacks an overt subject, even though the verb itself is lexically transitive, there is no morphological reflex of any detransitivization and on the level of semantic interpretation, there is an object (very general or existentially quantified). This bundle of facts has motivated various analyses which propose that such sentences do have so-called implicit objects (cf. Bibok 2008, 2010; Németh T. 2010, 2014, Ruda 2017, 2022). Such sentences are discussed in detail in Chapter X; here, we simply provide a handful of examples:

(15) *János a konyhában főzött.*

'John was cooking something in the kitchen.'

(16) *Mari a nappaliban olvasott.*

'Mary was reading something in the living room.'

(17) *Jobb adni, mint kapni.*

'It is better to give something than to receive something.'

(18) *A kormány épít, az ellenzék rombol.*

'The government builds things, the opposition destroys things.'

(19) *János szabadidejében fest.*

'John paints things in his free time. (i.e., He is an amateur painter.)'

4. True intransitives:

4.1 Unaccusativity cross-linguistically

In linguistic theory and description, two main groups of predicates have been traditionally distinguished based on the number of arguments that they take: single argument (or intransitive) verbs such as *run* or *arrive* and two-argument (or transitive) verbs such as *read*. In many accounts, a third group containing three-argument (or ditransitive) verbs such as *give* is also stipulated.

The Unaccusativity Hypothesis (Perlmutter 1978) proposes a refinement of this traditional categorization as it claims that cross-linguistically, the class of single-argument verbs is not homogeneous: rather, it can be neatly subdivided into two disjoint subgroups based on syntactic behaviour. The subjects of so-called unergative verbs display syntactic behaviour akin to that of the subject of two-argument verbs, whereas the subjects of so-called unaccusative verbs display syntactic behaviour similar to that of the object of two-argument verbs.

Accordingly, the unaccusativity literature (cf. Alexiadou 2004 for a standard overview and Neu and Akkus 2025 for a recent critical assessment) has identified a broad range of syntactic tests which separate unergatives from unaccusatives. By way of example, auxiliary selection is a diagnostic standardly used

for Indo-European languages with complex tense systems: unaccusative verbs take the copula (BE) as an auxiliary, while unergatives take a homophone of the verb of possession (HAVE):

(20) a. *Marie est arrivée en retard.*

Mary be.3SG arrive.PTCP.FM in lateness

'Mary arrived late.'

b. *Marie a rougi de honte.*

Mary have.3SG reddened-PTCP of shame

'Mary blushed with embarrassment.'

Furthermore, adjectival passive participles can be constructed from unaccusative and transitive verbs but not from unergative verbs (examples from Alexiadou 2004):

(21) a. *der geküßte Student*

the kiss.PTCP student

'the student that was kissed'

b. **der gearbeitete Student*

the work.PTCP student

intended: 'the student that has worked'

c. *der eingeschlafene Student*

the fall.asleep.PTCP student

'the student that has fallen asleep'

As far resultatives are concerned, only theme arguments (i.e., the objects of transitives or the subjects of unaccusatives) can be associated with resultatives (Simpson 1983, Levin and Rapaport-Hovav 1995, Csirmaz 2006):

(22) a. *John painted the door red.*

b. *John shouted hoarse.*

c. *The bottle broke open.*

These tests are to some extent language-specific: e.g. the auxiliary selection test does not apply to languages which lack complex tenses with auxiliaries. Below, we will offer an overview of the tests valid for Hungarian. What is common to all the tests, however, is that they lend strong support to the basic observation that the argument of an unaccusative behaves like the object of a transitive, and the argument of an unergative behaves like the subject of a transitive. Based on this, standard (generative) syntactic accounts suppose that the argument of an unaccusative is merged in the internal argument position (such as Spec,VP) whereas the argument of an unergative is merged in the external argument position (Spec,VoiceP or Spec,vP); from where it may be moved to the canonical position of the subject (depending on the language).

While the unaccusative-unergative distinction has been originally framed in syntactic terms, it has always been clear that it is a syntax-semantics interface phenomenon. Cross-linguistically, the subject (or external argument) position of a transitive verbs is highly correlated with an agent thematic role, and conversely, the object (or internal argument) position of transitive verbs is highly correlated with a

patient thematic role. Thus, syntactic subject- and objecthood is closely intertwined with argument semantics.

In this vein, one of the main concerns of linguistic research into unaccusativity has been to establish whether (and how) the syntactically defined unergative-unaccusative distinction can be correlated to the semantic characterisation of the predicates and arguments in question. Some authors (such as Dowty 1990 and Levin and Rappaport-Hovav 1995) followed a lexical semantic path, arguing that the unergativity/unaccusativity of a predicate is coded in the lexicon; while others have treated unaccusativity as a sentence-level phenomenon (e.g Borer 1994 and van Hout 2004), assuming a strong relationship between aspect and unaccusativity.

Dowty (1990) identifies two semantic proto-roles (that of proto-agent and proto-patient), and the position of an argument on the so-called agent-patient spectrum is derived from the amount of semantic properties it shares with either the proto-agent or the proto-patient cluster of properties. The proto-agent cluster includes the following properties: volitionality, sentience/perceptions, the causing of an event or a change of state in another participant, movement relative to the position of another participant, and existence independently of the event denoted by the verb. Proto-patient properties include: undergoing a change of state, being an incremental theme, being causally affected by another participant, being stationary relative to another participant, no existence independently of the event denoted by the verb. Verbs with a single argument that has solely or predominantly proto-agent properties are unergative; verbs with a single argument that has solely or predominantly proto-patient properties are unaccusative; verbs with a single argument with mixed properties are unstable and show mixed behaviour in terms of unaccusativity.

Dowty's (1990) model is stochastic (non-deterministic) in that it can readily accommodate (or even predicts) the existence of verbs which are neither purely unergative or purely unaccusative, but are to be found in the middle of what is termed an unergativity-unaccusativity spectrum. As we will see, Hungarian has such a set of verbs: semelfactives.

Levin & Rapaport-Hovav (1995) propose a more deterministic model, where the relationship between syntactic behaviour and semantic characterisation is modeled by way of so-called linking rules. Variations across languages with regard to the unaccusativity of certain verb classes are accommodated by stipulating variable ordering of these linking rules:

- (i) Immediate cause -> external argument
- (ii) Directed change -> internal argument
- (iii) Existence -> internal argument
- (iv) Other (default) -> internal argument

In its original and strongest form, the Unaccusativity Hypothesis stipulates that all single-argument verbs can be distinctly classified as either unergative or unaccusative. Subsequent research (Sorace 2000, Alexiadou 2004) has revealed that this is not the case: while there are indeed many verbs that displays a uniformly unergative or unaccusative behaviour, several others show mixed behaviour both intra- and cross-linguistically (examples below are from Alexiadou 2004). Thus, some verbs or verb classes (such as verbs of existence) are unergatives in some languages and unaccusatives in others:

(23) *I vampiri non sono mai esistiti.* -> unaccusative
thevampires not BE.3PL never exist.PTCP.PL
'Vampires never existed.'

(24) *There exist three versions of the manuscript.* -> unaccusative

(25) *Die Dinosaurier haben/*sind wirklich existiert.* -> unergative

The dinosaurs HAVE.3PL/BE.3PL really exist.PTCP

‘Dinosaurs did exist.’

(26) *Il a/*est été á l' université.* -> unergative

he HAVE.3SG/BE.3SG BE.PTCP at the university.

‘He was at the university.’

Additionally, within a given language, certain verbs / verb classes may display mixed behaviour:

(27) *La villa ha appartenuto / è appartenuta alla mia famiglia.*

the villa HAVE.3SG belong.PTCP.MS / BE.3SG belong.PTCP.FM to.the my family

‘The villa belonged to my family.’ This suggests that instead of a strictly dichotomic distinction, we should stipulate an unergative-unaccusative continuum (spectrum), with strongly unergative and strongly unaccusative verbs at either end, and verbs with varying degrees of mixed behaviour at the corresponding relative position inside the spectrum. Inspired by Dowty (1990), Sorace (2000) proposes the following model:

Semantic characterisation of verb/predicate Syntactic behaviour (auxiliary selection)

directed change of location

BE (least variation)

change of state

continuation of a pre-existing state

existence of state

uncontrolled process

controlled process, motional

controlled process, nonmotional

HAVE (least variation)



Both intra- and cross-linguistically, verbs expressing a directed change of location are consistently unaccusatives and verbs denoting non-motional controlled processes are unergatives. Verbs denoting an existence of state or an uncontrolled process display mixed syntactic behaviour cross-linguistically and, in some languages, intra-linguistically as well. The hierarchy is also implicational: if in a given language, verbs denoting the existence of a state are unaccusative, that all verb classes situated above them in the hierarchy are unaccusative too..

4.2 Unaccusativity in Hungarian

Below, we will discuss the landscape of intransitivity from three angles: semantics, syntax and morphology. To the best of our knowledge, the semantics of unaccusativity has not been thoroughly investigated with regard to Hungarian. However, as we will see, the basic facts appear to hold in Hungarian too. Thus, the single argument of an unergative tends to have proto-agent features (as discussed by Dowty 1990 and Sorace 2000) and the single argument of an unaccusative tends to have proto-patient features. This can be illustrated with verbs where the volitionality and control (two proto-agent features) can be manipulated, and the unaccusativity of the verb changes accordingly (cf. E. Abaffy 1978:X for additional examples):

(28) a. *A betörő kifutott a szobából.*

the burglar out.run.PST the room.ELA

'The burglar ran out of the room.'

- b. **A kifutott betörő fáradtan rogyott a földre.*

the out.run.PTCP burglar tiredly fall.PST.3SG the ground.ALL

intended: 'The burglar who has run out fell to the ground with exhaustion.'

- c. *A tej kifutott a fazékból.*

the milk out.run.PST.3SG the pot.ELA

'The milk ran out from (i.e. overflowed) the pot.'

- d. *A kifutott tej szörnyű szagot árasztott.*

the out.run.PTCP milk terrible smell.ACC emit.PST.3SG

'The milk that has run out produced a terrible smell.'

Also, Halm (2012) shows that so-called semelfactive verbs (see below) have a mixed set of proto-agent and proto-patient properties, and accordingly, they display mixed behaviour on the standard set of syntactic tests of unaccusativity. To sum up, there are strong indications that unaccusativity in Hungarian is a spectrum that can be described in terms of proto-agent and proto-patient properties in the vein of Dowty (1990); however, a methodical exploration of this has not yet been undertaken.

The morphosyntax of unaccusativity has received more attention. Bene (2010) is monograph exploring unaccusativity in Hungarian combining descriptive detail with some analysis from a standard generative perspective, whereas Márkus's (2015) dissertation focuses on transitivity-intransitivity alternations from a nanosyntactic perspective. Halm (2002) is a study of a special verb class in the middle of the unergative-unaccusative spectrum. In terms of the syntax of unaccusativity, the following tests have been identified:

Association with a verbal particle: In Hungarian, only transitive or unaccusative verbs (i.e., verbs having a theme argument) can be associated with a verbal particle (É. Kiss 2005):

- (29) *Feri megsütötte a kenyeret.*

Feri PRT.bake.PST.3SG.OBJ the bread.ACC

'Feri baked the bread.'

- (30) *Feri megérkezett.*

Feri PRT.arrive.PST.3SG

'Feri has arrived.'

- (31) **Feri elénekelt.*

Feri PRT.sing.PST.3SG

'Feri sang.'

Association with the pseudo-object *egyet*: The pseudo-object *egyet* 'one, once' can only be associated with unergatives (Kiefer 1992, Pinon 2001, Farkas (X), Dékány és Hegedűs (X)):

- (32) a. *Anna ugrott egyet.*

Anna jump.PST.3SG one.ACC

‘Anna jumped. (Anna made a jump.)’

- b. **Anna érkezett egyet.*

Anna arrive.PST.3SG one.ACC

Intended: ‘Anna arrived. (Anna made an arrival.)’

Association with an incorporated bare nominal subject: such subjects can only be associated with unaccusatives (Marácz 1989, É. Kiss 2002):

- (33) a. *Vendég érkezett.*

guest arrive.PST.3SG

‘There arrived a guest / some guests.’

- (34) b. **Munkás dolgozott.*

labourer work.PST.3SG

Association with a resultative verb modifier: In Hungarian, only transitive or unaccusative verbs (i.e., verbs having a theme argument) can be associated with a resultative verb modifier (Csirmaz 2006):

- (35) a. *Juli darabokra törte a vázát.* (transitive)

Juli piece.PL.ALL break.PST3SG.OBJ the vase.ACC

‘Juli broke the vase into pieces.’

- b. *A váza darabokra van törve.* (unaccusative)

the vase piece.PL.ALL be.3SG break.PTCP

‘The vase is (in a state of having been) broken into pieces.’

- c. *A váza darabokra tört.* (unaccusative)

the vase piece.PL.ALL break.PST.3SG

‘The vase broke into pieces.’

- (36) a. *Juli betegre nevette magát.* (pseudo-reflexive)

Juli ill.ALL laugh.PST.3SG.OBJ self.ACC

‘Juli laughed herself ill.’

- **Juli betegre van nevetve.* (unergative)

Juli ill.ALL be.3SG laugh.PTCP

intended: ‘Juli is in a state of having laughed (herself) ill.’

- **Juli betegre nevetett.* (unergative)

Juli ill.ALL laugh.PST.3SG

Intended: ‘Juli laughed (herself) ill.’

So-called *-t/tt*-marked adjectival participial phrases² (variously analyzed as expressing perfectivity and/or anteriority, cf. Imre-Temesy 1970, Komlósy 1992, Velcsov 1994, Laczkó 1995a-b, Alberti 1997, Kenesei 2000, Laczkó 2000, Lengyel 2000, É. Kiss 2002, É. Kiss 2003, Bene 2011, **Dékány és Bacskai-Atkari?**) can only be derived from verbs having a theme argument (i.e., transitives or unaccusatives). Consider (the examples are from É. Kiss 2002, the glosses are mine):

- (37) a. *az el-hangz-ott dal* (unaccusative)
the PRT-sound-PTCP song
'the song that has sounded'
- b. *az el-zongoráz-ott darab* (transitive)
the PRT-perform.on.piano-PTCP piece
the piece that was played on the piano
- c. **a zongoráz-ott fiú* (unergative)
the perform-PTCP boy
intended: 'the boy who has played on the piano'

Adverbial participles of state (also called predicative adverbial participles, cf. Imre-Temesi 1970, Komlósy 1992, Komlósy 1994, Velcsov 1994, Laczkó 1995, Alberti 1997, Kiefer 1998, Kiefer-Ladányi 2000, Laczkó 2000, Tóth 2000, Lengyel 2000, É. Kiss 2002) can only be derived from transitives and unaccusatives:

- (38) a. *János jól ki van fár-aszt-va.*
John well PRT be.3SG $\sqrt{\text{tire}}$ -TR-PTCP
- b. *János jól ki van fár-ad-va.*
John well PRT be.3SG $\sqrt{\text{tire}}$ -UNACC-PTCP
- c. **János jól ki van fut-va.*
John well PRT be.3SG $\sqrt{\text{tire}}$ -UNACC-PTCP

As far as the morphological reflexes of unaccusativity are concerned, these are discussed in detail by Bene and Márkus³. Our discussion below will heavily draw on these works, with some commentary and criticism as necessary. The various patterns will be discussed in the subchapters below.

² Somewhat confusingly, Hungarian has another *-t/tt* marked participle, the perfective counterpart of the imperfective *-ó* participle (Komlósy 1992, Laczkó 1995a-b, É. Kiss 2003, Bene 2011), and this participle can attach to unergatives as well:

- (1) a. *a gyalogl-ó bányászok*
the walk-PTCP miner.PL
'the miners who are walking'
- b. *?a gyalogol-t bányászok*
the walk-PTCP miner.PL
'the miners who have walked'

However, this participle is limited to certain registers (such as news reports) and otherwise rather marked.

³ Bene also includes a detailed overview of the treatment of unergatives, unaccusatives and middles in the linguistics literature from the 18th century up until today.

Non-derived unergatives are verbs which are not derived from transitives via the syntactic and/or semantic elimination of the internal argument: they never had an internal argument in the first place. Non-derived unergatives can be monomorphemic such as *fut* 'run' and *úszik*⁴ 'swim', or made up of a nominal stem and a verbalizer such as *táncol* 'dance':

- #### 4.4 Non-derived unaccusatives:

(42) tör-ik break-3SG 'break'
(43) érkez-ik arrive-3SG 'arrive'

Ø-Vszt⁵ pattern

(44)	a.	<i>fűgg</i>	b.	<i>fűgg-eszt</i>
		hang		hang-TR
		'hang _{unaccusative} '		'hang _{transitive} '
(45)	a.	<i>ill-ik</i>	b.	<i>ill-eszt</i>
		fit-3SG		fit-TR
		'fit _{unaccusative} '		'fit _{transitive} '

The morpheme *-Vsz* is glossed as TR, in order to clearly differentiate it from the productive, unselective causative suffix *-tVt* (to be discussed below). Other verb pairs in this paradigm include: *fogy* 'diminish' – *fogyaszt* 'reduce/consume', *rogy* 'crumple' – *rogyaszt* 'make crumple', *ugrik* 'jump' – *ugraszt* 'make jump', *fejlik* 'develop_{unacc}' – *fejleszt* 'develop_{tr}'. Some of the unaccusative verbs follow the regular paradigm and some the irregular *-ik* paradigm: this appears to be coincidental. (As we will discuss below, historically, the *-ik* paradigm encoded middle voice and its gradual spread from derived unaccusatives such as anticausatives onto non-derived unaccusatives has been described as an analogical

⁵ V stands for a vowel which is realized either as *a* or *e*, following vowel harmony.

phenomenon, cf. Halm 2020 and references therein.) None of the transitive forms follow the *-ik* paradigm.

Compared to the other alternation patterns, the hallmark of this pattern is that the unaccusative form is monomorphemic, certainly on the surface. (Of course, in the interest of a uniform analysis with the patterns to be discussed below, it is also possible to assume a phonologically zero unaccusative unacc suffix.)

Vd-Vszt

This pattern also includes pairs of verbs where one member is an unaccusative (traditionally called inchoative) and the other member is a transitive (traditionally called causative). Consider:

- (46) a. *fár-ad* b. *fár-aszt*
 √tire-UNACC √tire-TR (√ signifies category-neutral root)
 'tire, get tires' 'exhaust'
- (47) a. *éber-ed* > *ébred* b. *éber-eszt* > *ébreszt*
 alert_{Adj}-UNACC alert_{Adj}-TR
 'wake up' 'awaken'

The suffixes in this paradigm typically attach to category neutral roots. Some additional examples include: *roh-ad* – *roh-aszt*, *loh-ad* – *loh-aszt*, *korh-ad* – *kor-haszt*, *hal-ad* – *hal-aszt*, *rep-ed* – *rep-eszt*, *forr-ad*, *forr-aszt*, *zsibbad-zsibbaszt*, *akad-akaszt*, *ered-ereszt*, *fárad-fáraszt*, *hervad-hervaszt*, *olvad-olvaszt*, *fonnyad-fonnyaszt*, *apad-apaszt*, *dagad-dagaszt*, *ragad-ragaszt*. Rare instances of attachment to adjectival roots (47), nominal roots (*lyuk-ad* – *lyuk-aszt*) and possibly verbal roots (*éled-éleszt*) are also attested. (Although with *éled-éleszt*, it is debatable whether the root is the verb *él* or the adjective *élő*.) Verbs in this pattern uniformly do not follow the *-ik* paradigm.

-(V)l-(i)t

This pattern includes pairs of verbs where one member is an unaccusative (traditionally called inchoative) and the other member is a transitive (traditionally called causative). Consider:

- (48) a. *mély-ül* b. *mély-ít*
 deep_{Adj}-UNACC deep_{Adj}-TR
 'deepen_{unacc}' 'deepen_{tr}'
- (49) a. *vegy-ül* b. *vegy-ít*
 √mix-UNACC √mix-TR
 'get mixed, dissolve_{unacc}' 'mix, dissolve_{tr}'
- (50) a. *sü-l* b. *sü-t*
 √bake-UNACC √bake-TR
 'get baked' 'bake'

The suffixes in this paradigm attach to adjectives fairly productively: in addition to (48), a non-exhaustive list includes: (*szép* 'beautiful', *ép* 'intact, whole', *kék* 'blue', *tiszta* 'clean', *hülye* 'stupid',

tág 'wide', *szűk* 'narrow', *lágy* 'soft', *csúnya* 'ugly', *silány* 'flimsy', *gyors* 'fast', *lehetetlen* 'impossible'). With some adjectives, the stem needs to be augmented by the productive adjectivizer -s in order for -ít-suffixation to proceed. Consider:

- (51) a. *lila-ul* > *lilul* b. **lila-ít* > **lil-ít* c. *lilá-s-ít*
 purple- UNACC purple- TR purple-ADJ-TR
 'become purple-coloured' int.: 'turn purple-colored' 'turn purple-colored'

The suffixes in this paradigm also attach to a large number of category-neutral stems. In addition to (Xa,b), this includes *gyógy-* '√health' *pir-* '√red'⁶, *bor-* '√topple', *hár-* '√avert', *ker-* '√procure', *ok-* '√learn', *széd-* '√dizzy', *szor-* '√tight', *hű-* '√cold'. Many of these stems can also serve as an input of adjectivization:

- (52) a. *ok-ul* b. *ok-ít* c. *ok-os*
 √learn-UNACC √learn-TR √learn-ADJ
 'learn' 'teach' 'clever'
- (53) a. *hű-l* b. *hű-t* c. *hűv-ös / hű-s*
 √cold-UNACC √cold-TR √cold-ADJ / √cold-ADJ

Rather rarely, nominal stems also feature in this paradigm (other examples include *alap* 'base' and *alak* 'shape'):

- (54) a. *lap-ul* b. *lap-ít* c. *lap-os*
 sheet-UNACC sheet-TR sheet-ADJ
 'flatten_{unacc}' 'flatten_{tr}' 'flat_{adj}'

Typically, however, a nominal needs to be adjectivized first in order for -VI/-ít to apply:

- (55) a. *rész-es-ül* b. *rész-es-ít*
 part-ADJ-UNACC part-ADJ-TR
 'partake_{unacc}' 'provide_{tr}'

The verbs in this pattern follow the regular subject agreement paradigm, with a handful of exceptions such as *esik* 'fall' – *ejt* 'drop', *fejlik* 'develop_{unacc}' – *fej* 'develop_{tr}', *rejtik* 'hide' – *rejt* 'conceal', *feslik* 'fray' – *fejt* 'unravel'.

Vd-ít

This pattern includes pairs of verbs where one member is an unaccusative (traditionally called inchoative) and the other member is a transitive (traditionally called causative). Consider:

- (56) a. *édes-ed-ik* b. *édes-ít*
 sweet-UNACC-3SG sweet-TR

⁶ (Historically, the stem *pir* (or *pír*) was also a nominal, however, this is probably no longer transparent and thus, *pir* is best analyzed as a category-neutral root.)

- | | | |
|---------|-----------------------------|--------------------------|
| | 'sweeten _{unacc} ' | 'sweeten _{tr} ' |
| (57) a. | <i>szak-ad</i> | b. <i>szak-ít</i> |
| | √tear-UNACC | √tear-TR |
| | 'tear _{unacc} ' | 'tear _{tr} ' |

The suffixes in this paradigm attach to adjectives fairly productively. In addition to (Xa), a handful of examples include: *szomorú* 'sad', *magas* 'tall', *alacsony* 'small', *savanyú* 'sour', *bátor* 'brave', *lapos* 'flat', *szegény* 'poor', *gazdag* 'rich', *édes* 'sweet', *nedves* 'wet' stb.). The unaccusative form in the case of an adjectival stem follows the irregular *-ik* paradigm. With some adjectives, the adjectival stem needs to be augmented by the productive adjectivizer *-s* 'ADJ':

- | | | |
|---------|-------------------------|-------------------------|
| (58) a. | <i>népszerű-s-öd-ik</i> | b. <i>népszerű-s-ít</i> |
| | popular-ADJ-UNACC-3SG | popular-ADJ-TR |
| | 'become popular' | 'popularize' |

Interestingly, a small number of category-neutral stems also feature in this paradigm (*szak-* '√tear', *has-* '√split'): their unaccusative form, however, consistently follows the regular paradigm.

There is a broad division of functional load between the *-VI/-ít* paradigm and the *-Vd-ik/-ít* paradigm: most adjectives follow one or the other, while a handful participate with both paradigms, sometimes with a meaning split. Consider:

- | | | | |
|---------|-----------------|-------------------------------|-------------------|
| (59) a. | <i>igaz-ul</i> | b. <i>igaz-od-ik</i> | c. <i>igaz-ít</i> |
| | just-UNACC | just-UNACC-3SG | just-TR |
| | 'get justified' | 'get in line, adjust oneself' | 'adjust' |
-
- | | | | |
|---------|----------------------------|----------------------------|-------------------------|
| (60) a. | <i>fehér-ül</i> | b. <i>fehér-ed-ik</i> | c. <i>fehér-ít</i> |
| | white-UNACC | white-UNACC-3SG | white-TR |
| | 'whiten _{unacc} ' | 'whiten _{unacc} ' | 'whiten _{tr} ' |

While largely productive, the two paradigms also display some accidental (and maybe non-accidental) gaps. Consider

- | | | | |
|---------|------------------|----------------------|------------------|
| (61) a. | <i>?usz-ul</i> | b. <i>*usz-od-ik</i> | c. <i>usz-ít</i> |
| | √incite-UNACC | √incite-UNACC-3SG | √incite-TR |
| | 'become.incited' | 'become.incited' | 'incite' |
-
- | | | | |
|---------|----------------------------|----------------------------|-------------------------|
| (62) a. | <i>*kövér-ül</i> | b. <i>*kövér-ed-ik</i> | c. <i>kövér-ít</i> |
| | fat-UNACC | fat-UNACC-3SG | fat-TR |
| | 'fatten _{unacc} ' | 'fatten _{unacc} ' | 'fatten _{tr} ' |
-
- | | | | |
|---------|-----------------|-----------------------|-------------------|
| (63) a. | <i>*nagy-ul</i> | b. <i>*nagy-od-ik</i> | c. <i>nagy-ít</i> |
| | big-UNACC | big-UNACC-3SG | big-TR |
| | 'become.larger' | 'become.larger' | 'enlarge' |
-
- | | | | |
|---------|--------------------|--------------------------|----------------------|
| (64) a. | <i>*kicsiny-ül</i> | b. <i>*kicsiny-ed-ik</i> | c. <i>kicsiny-ít</i> |
|---------|--------------------|--------------------------|----------------------|

	small-UNACC	small-UNACC-3SG	small-TR
	'become.smaller'	'become.smaller'	'reduce'
(65)	a. <i>*nagy-obb-ul</i>	b. <i>nagy-obb-od-ik</i>	c. <i>nagy-obb-ít</i>
	big-COMP-UNACC	big-COMP-UNACC-3SG	big-COMP-TR
	'become.larger'	'become.larger'	'enlarge'
(66)	a. <i>*kis-ebb-ül</i>	b. <i>kis-ebb-ed-ik</i>	c. <i>kis-ebb-ít</i>
	small-COMP-UNACC	small-COMP-UNACC-3SG	small-COMP-TR
	'become.smaller'	'become.smaller'	'reduce'

The gaps concerning *nagy* 'big' and *kis/kicsiny* 'small' seem to be systematic and to the best of my knowledge, have not yet received an explanation.

As far as new words are concerned, the productive pattern seems to involve the adjectivizer *-s* 'ADJ' and the *-d/-ít* paradigm. Consider:

(67)	a. <i>pink-es-ed-ik</i>	b. <i>pink-es-ít</i>
	pink-ADJ-UNACC-3SG	pink-ADJ-TR
	'become pink-coloured'	'make pink-coloured'

-d-ul, -d-ít, -g, -g-Vt

This paradigm includes quartets of verb form: semelfactive-unaccusative, semelfactive-transitive, iterative-unaccusative and iterative-transitive. Consider:

(68)	a. <i>for-d-ul</i>	b. <i>for-d-ít</i>	c. <i>for-og</i>	d. <i>for-g-at</i>
	√turn-SEM-UNACC	√turn-SEM-TR	√turn-FQ	√turn-FQ-TR
	'turn _{unacc} (once)'	'turn _{tr} (once)'	'turn _{unacc} (repeatedly)'	'turn _{tr} (repeatedly)'

While the iterative-unaccusative form lacks an overt unaccusative suffix, it is plausible to assume that it has a null unaccusative suffix. (The alternative would be to assume that *-g* is a portmanteau FQ.UNACC morpheme, however, this would make the analysis of the iterative-transitive form rather complicated.) Note also that the sequence *-g-Vt* 'FQ-TR' is homophonous with the diminutive-iterative suffix *-gVt* 'DIM' which attaches to verbs (transitives, unaccusatives and unergatives alike e.g. *Mari ép-ít-get-i a karrierjét. Mari énekelget. Eszter ébredeszget*). While surface-identical, these suffixes (suffix complexes) have clearly different functions: *-gVt* 'DIM' has no verbalizing function and it does not affect valency.

The suffixes in this paradigm attach to category-neutral roots denoting physical movement or the emission of sound (the latter typically have an onomatopoeic flavour). This paradigm is of limited productivity. In addition to (68), it includes *rán-* '√jerk', *len-* '√swing', *moz-* '√move', *pör-/per-* '√spin', *per-* '√peel.off', *cse-* '√ring', *kon-* '√ring', *zen-* '√ring', *pen-* '√pluck', *zör-* '√rattle', *mor-* '√grumble', *hör-* '√gurgle', *gör-* '√roll', *csör-* '√rattle', *nyikor-* '√creak', *ing-* '√pendulate', *jaj-* '√wail', *boly-* '√roam', *raj-* '√enthuse', *zaj-* '√clamour'. With some roots, the paradigm is deficient. Thus, *hör-*, *mor-*

and *jaj-* (verbs of sound emission with animate argument) lack the transitive form, while *zaj-* (also a verb of sound emission with animate argument) only has an unaccusative-iterative form:⁷

- (69) a. *hör-d-ul* b. **hör-d-ít* c. *hör-ög* d. **hör-g-et*
 √gurgle-SEM-UNACC √gurgle-SEM-TR √gurgle-FQ √gurgle-FQ-TR
 'gurgle_{unacc} (once)' 'gurgle_{tr} (once)' 'gurgle_{unacc} (repeat.)' 'gurgle_{tr} (repeat.)'

Raj '√enthuse' only has the frequentative unaccusative form *raj-ong*. In the case of *in-* '√pendulate', there has been a meaning split:

- (70) a. *in-d-ul* b. *in-d-ít* c. *in-og* d. *in-g-at*
 √pend.-SEM-UNACC √pend.-SEM-TR √pend.-FQ √pend.-FQ-TR
 'get.moving' 'bring into motion' 'sway_{unacc}' 'sway_{tr}'

Note that the FQ suffix is spelled out with some roots (*jaj-*, *boly-*, *raj-*, *zaj-*) as *-ong* (as opposed *-og*): the reasons for this are unclear. (Interestingly, in the transitive form, the fq suffix is always spelled out as *-og*).

Finally, note that some verbs appear to be syncretic across different paradigms. Thus, the monomorphemic stative verb *fáj* 'hurt_{unacc}' can participate in the semelfactive forms of this paradigm (but not the iterative ones): this is unusual as this paradigm normally only admits category-neutral stems. The morphologically semelfactive forms have a telic reading

- (71) a. *fáj* b. *fáj-d-ul* c. *fáj-d-ít*
 hurt hurt-SEM-UNACC hurt-SEM-TR
 'hurt_{unacc} (atelic)' 'hurt_{unacc} (telic)' 'hurt_{tr} (telic)'

The adjective *bús* 'sad' is syncretic across the *-l/-ít* and the *-d-ul*, *-d-ít*, *-g*, *-g-Vt* paradigms, and only has unaccusative forms:

- (72) a. *bús-ul* b. *bús-ong*
 sad-UNACC sad-FQ
 'feel sad' 'feel sad (for an extended period or habitually)'

The stem *fesz-* '√tense' is syncretic between the *-l/-ít* and the *-d-ul*, *-d-ít*, *-g*, *-g-at* paradigms:

- (73) a. *fesz-ül* b. *fesz-ít* c. *fesz-eng* d. *fesz-eg-et*
 √tense-UNACC √tense-TR √tense-FQ √tense-FQ-TR
 'strain_{unacc}' 'strain_{tr}' 'feel tense' 'apply force repeatedly to open up'

-g, -g-tet, -en, en-t

This paradigm involves verbs of motion and verbs of emission (incl. sound emission). This paradigm includes quartets of verb form: semelfactive-unaccusative, semelfactive-transitive, iterative-unaccusative and iterative-transitive. Consider:

- (74) a. *lobb-an* b. *lobb-an-t* c. *lob-og* d. *lob-og-tat*

⁷ Note that *jaj-g-at* exists, however, it is not a transitive form, it is an iterative unaccusative form, synonymous with *jaj-ong*

√flutter-UNACC	√flutter-UNACC-TR	√flutter-FQ	flutter-FQ-TR
'flutter _{unacc} /flicker once'	'set ablaze/flutter _{tr} '	'flutter _{unacc} /flicker'	'wave'

While the iterative-unaccusative form lacks an overt unaccusative suffix, it is plausible to assume that it has a null unaccusative suffix. (The alternative would be to assume that -g is a portmanteau FQ.UNACC morpheme, however, this would make the analysis of the iterative-transitive form rather complicated.) Note also that the transitivizer *-tat* is homophonous with the productive causative suffix *-tat*.

The suffixes in this paradigm overwhelmingly attach to category-neutral roots denoting the emission of sound or light, (the former typically have an onomatopoeic flavour). Two potential exceptions to category-neutrality are the nominals *csöpp/csepp* 'drop' and *lob* 'flame, flicker'. This paradigm is of limited productivity. In addition to (74), it includes *csöp/csep-* 'drop_N', *rob-* '√blast', *csök-* '√decrease', *döb-* '√astound', *hök-* '√recoil', *dob-* '√thud', *serk-* '√stimulus', *csur/csor-* '√trickle', *leb-* '√float', *patt-* '√bounce'.

With some roots, the paradigm is deficient. Thus, *döb-* and *serk-* and *csök-* lack the iterative forms while *rob-* lacks the iterative-transitive form. Some roots display syncretism:

(75) a. <i>hök-öl</i>	b. <i>*hök-ít</i>	c. <i>hökk-en</i>	d. <i>hökk-en-t</i>
√recoil-UNACC	√recoil-TR	√recoil-UNACC	√recoil-UNACC-TR
'recoil'	'make recoil'	'recoil, flinch'	'astonish'

zero, -g, -get

This verb-of-motion paradigm involves triplets of verbal forms transitive, unaccusative-iterative, transitive-iterative. Consider:

(76) a. <i>teker</i>	b. <i>teker-eg</i>	c. <i>teker-g-et</i>
turn	turn-FQ	turn-FQ-TR
'turn _{tr} '	'turn _{unacc} repeatedly'	'turn _{tr} repeatedly'

This paradigm is atypical in the sense that the transitive form is unmarked. Because of this, one could even argue that this paradigm should be classed under 'derived unaccusatives'. However, in terms of its morphological signature (e.g. the *-og* unacc suffix, regular subject conjugation), it does not fit naturally with 'derived unaccusatives' (where a different set of middle suffixes are involved and where the verb follows the irregular *-ik* conjugation), rather, it seems to belong to the verbs exhibiting inchoative-transitive alternation. Note also that *-g-at* 'FQ-TR' is homophonous with the productive diminutive *-gat* 'DIM'. Since *-gat* in this paradigm attaches to a verb, it may be analyzed either way. Verbs in this paradigms include: *teker* 'turn' and *kavar* 'stir'.

Naturally, it is possible to involve the same set of verbs in a bona fide middle (anticausative) construction:

(77) a. <i>teker</i>	b. <i>teker-ed-ik</i>
turn	turn-MID-3SG
'turn _{tr} '	'turn _{unacc} repeatedly'

5 Middle voice (or: Derived unaccusatives and unergatives)

This chapter considers middle voice (cf. Halm 2020 and references), which can be characterized a systematic and morphologically marked transitive-intransitive pattern showing the following characteristics: (i) the transitive form is identical to the verb stem, (ii) the intransitive form is derived by the addition of a suffix (mid) right after the stem and (iii) the intransitive form follows the irregular -ik subject agreement paradigm. Analytically, middle voice can be considered a morphosyntactic operation which suppresses the external or internal argument of an originally transitive verb and thus yields what we might term a derived unergative or a derived unaccusative.

In Modern Hungarian, middle voice has the following subtypes:

- (78) a. *János be-csuk egy ajtót.* transitive
 John PRT-close.3SG a door.ACC
 ‘John closes a door.’
- b. *Egy ajtó be-csuk-ód-ik.* anticausative
 a door PRT-close-MID-3SG
 ‘A door gets closed. / A door closes.’
- (79) a. *Anna épít egy házat.* transitive
 Anne build-3SG a house.ACC
 ‘Anne builds a house.’
- b. *A ház épít-őd-ik.* mediopassive
 thehouse build-MID-3SG
 ‘The house is being built.’
- (80) a. *Feri meg-mos egy almát.* transitive
 Frank PRT-wash-3SG a apple.ACC
 ‘Frank rinses (lit. washes) an apple.’
- b. *Feri meg-mos-akod-ik.* reflexive
 Frank PRT-wash-MID-3SGMID
 ‘Frank washes himself.’
- (81) a. *Eszter lát minden csúcsot innen.* transitive
 Esthersee-3SG every summit.ACC here.from
 ‘From here, Esther sees all the summits.’
- b. *Minden csúcs lát-sz-ik innen.* dispositional middle
 every summit see-MID-3SG here.from
 ‘From here, all the summits are visible / can be seen.’
- (82) a. *András épít egy házat.* transitive
 Andrew build-3SG a house.ACC

‘Andrew is building a house.’

- b. András épít-kez-ik. antipassive

Andrew build-MID-3SG

‘Andrew is building. (Andrew is involved in an unspecified building project.)’

The subtypes of middle voice differ across two dimensions: (i) whether valency reduction is to be interpreted in syntactic terms (i.e. whether the position housing the external argument is projected or not) or semantic terms (whether an external argument is present in the semantic interpretation) and (ii) whether it is the external argument (anticausatives, mediopassives, dispositional middles and reflexives) or the internal argument (antipassive) that is suppressed.

In anticausatives, mediopassives, dispositional middles and reflexives, the external argument is syntactically suppressed (cf. Alexiadou, Anagnostopoulou and Schäfer 2015 for a cross-linguistic perspective). In terms of semantics, however, there are crucial differences. While with mediopassives, there is typically an understood agent which can actually be overtly reintroduced as an oblique argument (a *by*-phrase), this is not the case with anticausatives: these fully lack an agent role. Dispositional middles on the other hand are understood as modal-generic statements: (81b) means that generally speaking, everyone can see all the summits from here. In reflexives, there is an implicit external argument which is coreferential with the internal argument (cf. Alexiadou 2014). In antipassives, on the other hand, it is the internal argument which is syntactically suppressed, while in terms of semantics, there is typically an understood object which can often be overtly introduced as an oblique argument.

In terms of morphology, in Modern Hungarian, mediality is overtly encoded by a variety of mostly semi-productive middle suffixes:

- | | | | | | |
|------|-------------|--------------------|-------------------|----------------------|---------------|
| (83) | a. -sz- | <i>lát-sz-ik</i> | (see-MID-3SG) | ‘it seems’ | DISP. MIDDLE |
| | b. -d- | <i>mos-d-ik</i> | (wash-MID-3SG) | ‘she washes herself’ | REFLEXIVE |
| | c. -(V)kVz- | <i>imád-koz-ik</i> | (worship-MID-3SG) | ‘she prays’ | ANTIPASSIVE |
| | d. -(V)kVd- | <i>ver-eked-ik</i> | (beat-MID-3SG) | ‘she fights’ | ANTIPASSIVE |
| | e. -Vd- | <i>kever-ed-ik</i> | (mix-MID-3SG) | ‘it gets mixed’ | ANTICAUSATIVE |
| | f. -V:d- | <i>üt-őd-ik</i> | (hit-MID-3SG) | ‘it gets hit’ | ANTICAUSATIVE |

The landscape of middle suffixes is fragmented: there is no one-to-one correspondence between flavours of mediality and different middle suffixes. Note e.g. that the same suffix -(V)k(V)z- can appear in a reflexive, an antipassive and a reciprocal:

- | | | | |
|------|----|--|------------------------|
| (84) | a. | <i>szépít-kez-ik</i> | REFLEXIVE |
| | | beautify-MID-3SG | |
| | | ‘beautifies oneself, do one’s makeup’ | |
| | b. | <i>épít-kez-ik</i> | ANTIPASSIVE |
| | | build-MID-3SG | |
| | | ‘build around, be involved in an unspecified building project’ | |
| | c. | <i>vitat-koz-ik</i> | ANTIPASSIVE/RECIPROCAL |
| | | dispute-MID-3SG | |

‘be involved in a debate, debate with one another’

There are two exceptions to this irregularity. With anticausatives and mediopassives, *-V:d* is a productive suffix (Komlósy 2000, Márkus 2015), and dispositional middles typically involve the suffix *-sz-*.

Suffix stacking (the cross-linguistically well-known phenomenon of a semi-productive voice suffix being reinforced by a productive one, cf. Polinsky 2013 and references) is also attested. Specifically, dispositional middles are in the process of being reinforced by the productive anticausative suffix:

- (85) a. *lát-sz-ik* *->* *lát-sz-ód-ik*
see-MID-3SG see-MID-MID-3SG
‘seem’ ‘seem’
- b. *hall-atsz-ik* *->* *hall-atsz-ód-ik*
hear-MID-3SG hear-MID-MID-3SG
‘can be heard’ ‘can be heard’

Finally, one has to mention that while middle voice is overwhelmingly marked by dedicated, overt middle voice suffixes in Modern Hungarian (as opposed to Old Hungarian, where middle voice was marked by a separate subject agreement paradigm), there exist a handful of exceptions. *Tör* is a fossil from Old Hungarian in that the active-middle alternation is marked by subject agreement paradigm:

- (87) a. *Mari jeget tör.*
Mary ice.ACC break.3SG
‘Mary is breaking some ice.’
- b. *A jég könnyen tör-ik.*
the ice easily break.3SG
‘Ice breaks easily.’

Fest, *mutat* and *(ki)néz* exhibit totally unmarked active-middle alternation:

- (88) a. *János aktokat fest.* transitive
John nude.PL.ACC paint.3SG
‘John paints nudes.’
- b. *A helyzet rosszul fest.* dispositional middle
the situation badly paint.3SG
‘The situation looks bleak.’
- (89) a. *Anna példát mutat.* transitive
Anna example.ACC show.3SG
‘Anna sets an example.’
- b. *Ez a nyakkendő jól mutat Andráson.* dispositional middle
this the tie well show.3SG Andrew.SUP

'This tie looks good on Andrew.'

- (90) a. *Mari képeket néz.* transitive

Mary picture.PL.ACC look.3SG

'Mary is looking at pictures.'

- b. *Mari jól néz ki.* dispositional middle

Mary well look.3SG PRT

'Mary looks good.'

Before concluding this chapter, a brief remark is in order about the combination possibilities of the suffixes discussed above. The suffixes discussed in the section on non-derived unaccusatives and unergatives have the following functions: (i) verbalization (i.e., turning category-neutral stems, nominals or adjectives into verbs), (ii) denoting frequentative or semelfactive aspect and (iii) causativization. Note also that, as we have seen, they directly attached to the lexical stem, and it is possible to attach more than one such suffix to the stem. In contrast, middle voice suffixes never attach to a non-verbal stem, their sole function is the encoding of voice alternation, and they always follow verbalizing suffixes, if any:

- (91) *Külön figyelem for-d-ít-ód-ik a megelőzés szerepére.*
extra attention √turn-SEM-TR-MID-3SG the prevention role.3SG.SUB

'Extra attention is being paid to the role of prevention.'

This can result in complex derivations. E.g., in (91) above, causative *-ít* and anticausative *-ód* in essence cancel each other out. Thus, (91) is synonymous with (92) below:

- (92) *Külön figyelem for-d-ul a megelőzés szerepére.*
extra attention √turn-SEM-UNACC the prevention role.3SG.SUB

'Extra attention is being paid to the role of prevention.'

The suffixes discussed in Section 4.4 have the following functions: verbalization, encoding an inchoative-causative (or unaccusative-transitive) alternation, and the encoding of event type (semelfactive vs. frequentative). Because of this, they may be analyzed as exponents of v heads. The suffixes discussed in Section 5 lend themselves to analysis as exponents of Voice heads. The productive causative suffix *-tat* is plausibly an exponent of a Caus head. The order of the elements is as follows:

- (93) root < V_{sem/freq} < V_{unacc/tr} < caus < Voice

Consider:

- (94) *Éppen a természetesség/műviség hagyományos jelentéstartománya forgattatódik fel ebben a költészetben (is).*

for-g-at-tat-ód-ik

√turn-FREQ-TR-CAUS-MID-3SG

This suggests that Hungarian is a (doubly) split vP/VoiceP language (cf. Harley 2017 and references therein), where the vP and the VoiceP layer are clearly distinct, and the vP layer itself is also split into two.

[Further work: what about the very flexible denominal verbalizer *-ol*, which apparently creates transitives, unergatives and also unaccusatives from nouns and onomatopoeic words:

taps-ol unergative

clap_N-VBZ

'clap_V'

csomag-ol transitive

pack_N-VBZ

'wrap up, pack away'

klapp-ol unaccusative

onomatopoeic-VBZ

'go according to plan'

(It is interesting that all the transitives with *-ol* are very happy with an implicit object – maybe because the noun that the verbalizer attaches to kind of refers to the implicit object?)

References